

Behind Your Stay

The choices behind a stay at Alpine House

PREPARED IN PARTNERSHIP
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RESPONSIBLE HOSPITALITY

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HOSPITALITY



A guestroom balcony.

CONTENTS

WHAT WE STAND FOR	*A house first*	3
THEN & NOW	*A house that has always made room*	5
THE BUILDING	*Keep what's worth keeping*	9
BY THE NUMBERS	*Planet · People · Place*	12
WHAT IT TAKES	*The practices, choices, and stories behind running the house*	15
WHAT'S NEXT	*Where we're headed*	26
WHAT YOU CAN DO	*Travel like you mean to come back*	30
THE FINE PRINT	*Notes on the numbers*	34



WHAT WE STAND FOR

A house first.

Alpine House is a house before it’s a hotel. Guests find each other here over coffee in the living room, on the lawn in the late afternoon, at the bar in the evening. What draws people out of their rooms is usually something someone made: an artist at work, a print worth asking about, a chair with a story behind it.

What we care about

We believe in paying attention to what was here before us, making room for what is here now, and leaving the house in better shape for whoever comes next. And these are the things that matter to us:



TOGETHERNESS

The best moments here happen because someone feels at home enough to sit down, stay awhile, and say something to a stranger.

LIVING CULTURE

Artists and makers come and go through this house. So do the people who work here and live in this valley year-round. We want guests to encounter Jackson as it is, not a version made only for visitors.

RESTRAINT

What already exists is often better than what could be ordered new. Keeping, repairing, and reusing is the standard we hold every day.

THE VALLEY

The mountains set the terms here: the light, the seasons, how long the winter runs. This house was built to sit inside that landscape, not above it.



ALPINE HOUSE THEN & NOW

A house that has always made room.

Jackson residents Hans and Nancy Johnstone had spent years skiing and racing across the Alps and Scandinavia, both Olympians.

What stayed with them were the family-run mountain guest houses they knew there: small and unfussy, wood and down, no brand, and the same people at breakfast you'd seen on the trail. Jackson had nothing quite like it.

They found a classified ad for a beat-up log cabin on a commercially zoned lot in town. They moved the cabin to the back, lived in it, and in 1994 opened seven rooms and a kitchen on the front of the lot. The timber frame was built in true mortise-and-tenon construction from recycled timbers out of a Washington State warehouse.

After a friend next door decided to sell her house and barn, fifteen more rooms were added in 2001. The Johnstones won a variance to keep the two spruce trees out front, which were slated to become a parking lot. Nothing on the site was demolished. The neighbor's house and barn were moved, and the original cabin became part of the elementary school. Their parents shopped for Scandinavian-looking vintage furniture in the Northeast and drove what they found back in a U-Haul.

For more than two decades, the Johnstones ran Alpine House as a small, independent hotel: affordable, personable, and closely connected to the town around it. Guests came back year after year, and the house developed a reputation among European travelers, skiers priced out of the village, and local outfitters. They also cared about conservation and responsible practices long before those ideas were common in hospitality, and pursued sustainability certification.

1994

Seven rooms and a kitchen open on the front of the lot

2001

Fifteen more rooms; the spruce trees are saved

2020

Erik Warner carries the house forward

2026

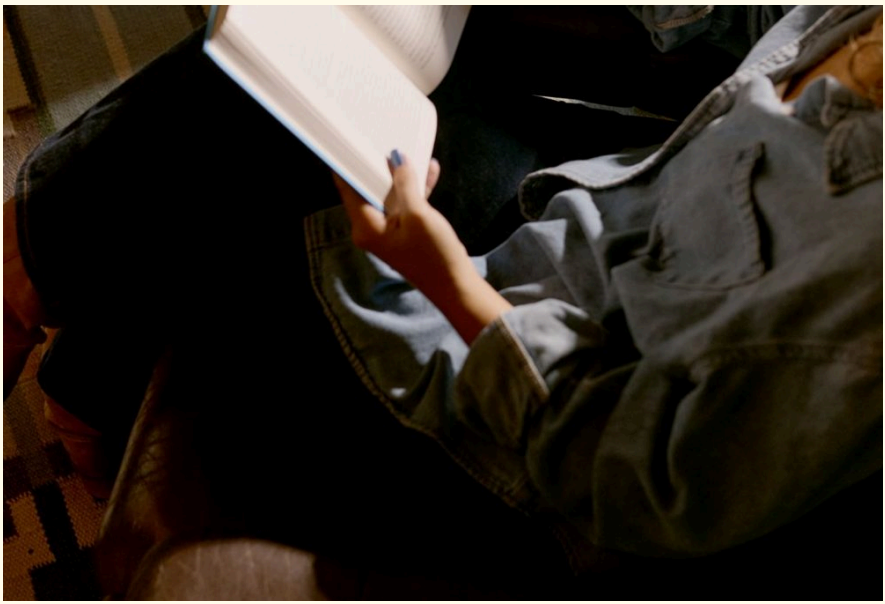
A full renovation that keeps the frame, the rooms, the trees

When the Johnstones decided it was time to retire, they wanted to be sure the house would be cared for by someone who understood what made it special. They looked across the street to their neighbor, hotelier Erik Warner.

Erik acquired Alpine House in 2020, bringing it into the small group of independent properties he operated on the block, alongside the Anvil across the street and Glorietta next door. The properties were different, but the approach was shared: keep them independent, stay connected to the town, and make room for the people who live and work here.

That continuity mattered. Alpine House didn’t need to become something else. It needed someone willing to carry it forward.

In 2026, the house went through a full renovation. The brief was narrow on purpose: keep the name, keep the vision, improve what was already here. The frame stayed. The gathering rooms stayed. The spruce trees stayed.





What changed was who the house is making room for. Jackson has no shortage of places built for skiers. What it has less of is room for the people making things here. The inn that once filled with athletes now has a permanent home for an artist in residence, regional work in every guestroom, and rooms set aside for the valley's own.

The instinct hasn't changed since 1994: find what the town needs a place for, and give it a house.



THE BUILDING

Keep what's worth keeping.

In 2026, Alpine House went through a full renovation with a simple aim: to keep everything that made Alpine feel like a house, just enhance it.

That called for someone who would respect the building's identity instead of overwriting it. We found her in Elizabeth Roberts.

Elizabeth was trained in historic preservation and spent most of her career restoring nineteenth-century townhouses. Alpine House was one of her first hotel projects, which is part of why we called her.

Just like the Johnstones did 25 years earlier, Elizabeth built the interiors largely from vintage pieces and reused what was already there. Every room is different. The team worked with dealers around the country, bid at live auctions, and sent found pieces to a Texas workroom for reupholstering.

The building itself was mostly left alone: the same walls, the same gathering rooms, the same kitchen. The majority of the old furniture was either reused, donated, or repurposed, which meant 331 lbs. of waste diverted from landfill.



A few things we kept or found

- Danish and Scandinavian mid-century pieces, including Farstrup leather lounge chairs from the 1960s, and brutalist pine coffee tables from the 1970s.
- American-made vintage pieces, including a mid-century office chair in the lobby and a reclaimed-wood coffee table in the guestrooms, sourced from Westport Auction in Connecticut and Chairish, Seattle Furniture and Golden Oldies Antiques – not a factory in Guangdong.
- Art from historic and contemporary artists whose work is rooted in the heritage of the region.

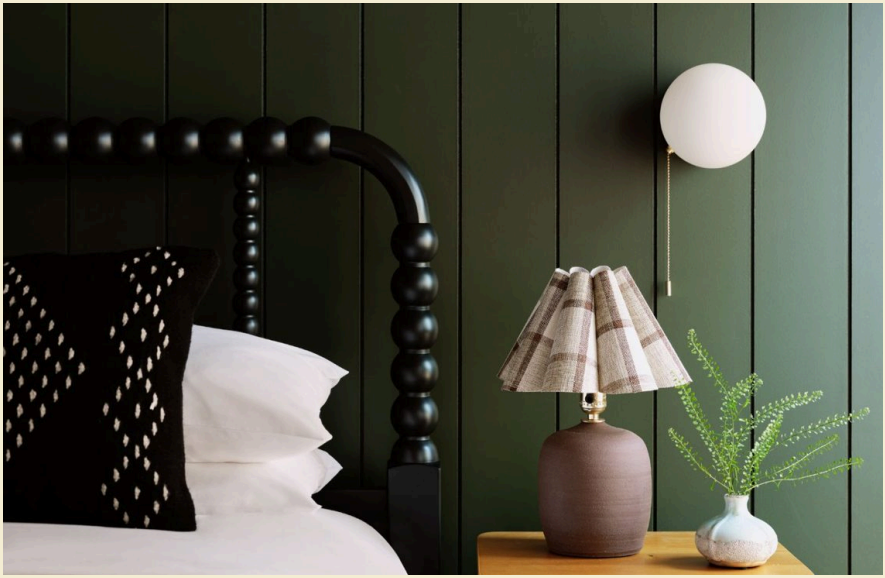
The renovation went through a MindClick assessment focused on the health and environmental characteristics of the new materials and found that:

63%

of surface areas were made of biodegradable, recyclable or reusable materials

64%

of the guestroom went to health, wellness & responsibly sourced products



Planet

ENERGY

24% above similar hotels



Energy used per occupied room night

WATER

11% below similar hotels



Water used per occupied room

WASTE GENERATED

38% below global average



Waste generated per occupied room

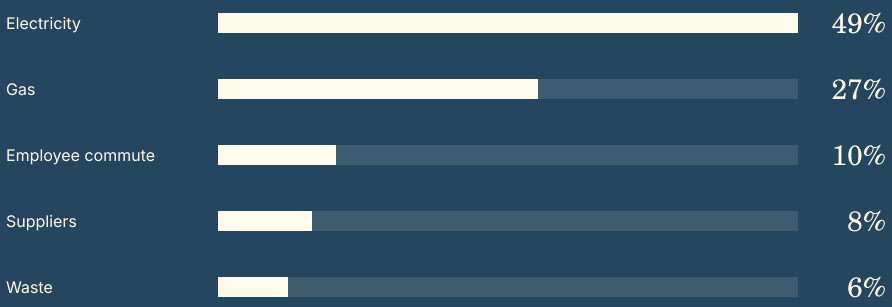
CARBON FOOTPRINT

35% above similar hotels



CO_2e emitted per guest night

HIGHEST AREAS OF EMISSIONS



Given that electricity was such a high part of the emissions, in 2026, we moved to 100% renewable energy, which lowered our carbon footprint by 47% to

9.88 kg CO_2 / room night

45% below similar hotels

RENOVATION

For our 2026 renovation, we reused and repurposed wherever possible. We worked with MindClick to calculate what we saved:

502 kg of shipping emissions avoided through the use of vintage furniture

922 kg of CO_2e avoided in manufacturing & shipping

331 lbs. of waste diverted from landfill through circular practices

The methodology on how these figures were calculated and where the data comes from is detailed on pages 34–35.

PEOPLE

100%
of team members live locally
compared to 57% Teton County levels

35%
of employees are in hotel-subsidized housing

10%
of rooms are available for live-in staff and artists

67%
of total staff earn at least the living wage
compared to 31% US average

50%
of women are in leadership roles
compared to 49% nationally

PLACE

28%
of suppliers are based in Jackson

60%
of top supplier spend stays in Wyoming

$180K
in annual room value is dedicated to artists

12
artists hosted per year

100%
non-institutional ownership

100%
independent, values-aligned management



The methodology on how these figures were calculated and where the data comes from is detailed on pages 34–35.



WHAT IT TAKES

The practices, choices, and stories behind running the house.



WHAT IT TAKES

Making room for guests to gather

- We run on fully renewable electricity, and 80% of our lighting is LED.
- 63% of surface areas are made of biodegradable, recyclable, or reusable materials.
- The majority of our furniture is vintage.
- The historic art in the house pays tribute to Jackson's history.
- Seasonal wellness gatherings are open to the community and bring in small local businesses and instructors, with a focus on health and connection.

In the bar and the library



The etchings hanging in the bar and library are by Hans Kleiber, who came to Wyoming in 1907 hoping to be an artist and became a forest ranger instead. He spent sixteen years with the U.S. Forest Service in the Bighorns, laying out roads and trails still in use today, mapping unfamiliar country in the Big Horn, Washakie, Wind River, and Bridger forests, fighting fires, and stringing telephone lines between ranger stations. The sketches and notes he made in the backcountry became the source material for everything that followed.

He resigned in 1923 to make art full time. Largely self-taught, he built his own printing press from gears and rollers cast at the Sheridan Foundry. A guest at a nearby guest ranch saw the work and arranged his first major show in Boston. He won the Silver Medal from the California Print Makers Society in 1931 and was given a showing at the Smithsonian in 1944. A critic called him the Etcher Laureate of the Big Horns.

His work is now held by the Library of Congress, the Wyoming State Art Museum, and the Buffalo Bill Center in Cody, among others. A guest's eye helped put it there in the first place.



WHAT IT TAKES

Making room for guests to slow down

- Most of the furniture in this room was salvaged from earlier versions of Alpine House or custom-made for it. Nothing came from a catalogue, and no two rooms are alike.
- Beautyrest Black Napa mattresses are made in the USA with CertiPUR-US certified foam: no added formaldehyde, no flame-retardant chemicals, and tested for low emissions.
- Toiletries are refillable, so no single-use plastic leaves this room. We chose Aesop because it is a Certified B Corporation with Leaping Bunny-approved, vegan formulations.
- We chose ceramic tile and Greenguard-certified paint because they have lower emissions than many new synthetic surfaces.
- The carpet is 40% reclaimed fishing net and the wallcovering is woven agave. Both make use of materials that might otherwise become waste.





On your wall

Each guestroom contains a unique print made by hand in Missoula. David Miles Lusk works under the name Anomal Press, a splice of “animal” and “anomaly,” and has been making relief prints since a high school art teacher put a carving tool in his hand twenty years ago.

Every design is drawn, carved, and printed by him. No reproduction. No catalog. No two rooms alike.

His subjects run from leaf moss to megafauna, and his work is always grounded on research. During a residency at the Montana Natural History Center, he spent a month working from the collection’s specimens: pronghorn, beaver, grizzly, wood duck, sagebrush. That’s where we found him.

If you want one of your own, he sells at markets around Missoula and at anomalpress.com.

His imagery also runs across the Noguchi fixture at the center of the lounge, painted by hand onto the shade especially for the house.

Making room for a good start

- Breakfast is a short buffet with the rest ordered to the table. A long buffet looks generous and often ends up in the bin. This way, we cook what people actually eat.
- The food is made here: pastries from the oven, yogurt with fruit compote, warm egg dishes.
- Produce is sourced local first, regional second, and farther afield only when there's no other option.
- Coffee is roasted by Snake River Roasting, just down the street.
- The majority of snacks in the room come from Jackson and the surrounding valley.







Why the trees are still here

In the morning, two spruce trees shade the lawn between the two halves of the house. They're about 65 years old, and their kind has grown on this valley floor far longer than there has been a town here. Blue spruce grows wild across the floor of Jackson Hole, especially along the Snake River.

We were asked to cut them down during the renovation. We kept them, the same way the Johnstones did in 2001, when the town's rules called for a parking lot where the trees stood and they applied for a variance instead.

Spruce grows slowly, reaching full size in about 150 years and living for centuries. In the backcountry, it gives deer, elk, moose, bighorn sheep, and bear a place for shelter. It does something similar here, in a smaller way. Community events gather beneath the trees. Guests read in their shade. Our team takes breaks there.

Keeping what stood here before us is one way we try to honor the valley's lineage. These trees were here first.

Making room for the people behind the house

- There is always a manager in residence. The person responsible for the house also lives in it.
- We hire from Jackson first, so the people running the house know the valley as well as the guests hope to.
- We house part of our team at a subsidized rate, and hold rooms in the house itself for staff and resident artists.
- We set pay against what it actually costs to live in Teton County, not against the minimum.
- Every full-time employee receives top-of-the-line benefits, including health.
- We share one team with the Anvil across the street, so work carries across both houses through the seasons.



Someone has always lived here

When Hans and Nancy Johnstone opened this house in 1994, they lived in the old log cabin at the back of the lot. Later they moved into room 122 and raised a baby there. For more than two decades, the people who ran Alpine House were also the people who woke up in it.

That's still true. There is always a manager living here: someone who knows how the house sounds at 2 a.m., which pipes knock in January, and which guests want to be left alone.



Making room for makers

- One room in the house always belongs to an artist. Our Uncommon Artist residency program has a permanent home here, so for most of the year someone is always working here.
- Our resident artists lead workshops open to the whole town and teach different crafts.
- House Reads brings Jackson Hole writers into the living room to read from their work and connect with each other.







Why there's always someone creating here

The reason Yellowstone was protected as a national park is that two artists helped make it believable. When painter Thomas Moran and photographer William Henry Jackson came through with the 1871 Hayden Expedition, accounts of boiling mud and water shooting from the ground were dismissed back East as tall tales. Their pictures gave people something they could see. In 1872, Congress protected the place.

Art culture in this valley is older than ski culture. The first gallery in Jackson Hole was a canvas tent on the shore of Jenny Lake in the 1920s, paintings on a clothesline, with a sign across the roof reading PICTURES. The painters who sold from it came from Denmark, Idaho, and elsewhere. They arrived, found their subject in the Tetons, and stayed as long as they could manage it. Most worked other jobs to make it possible: trail crews, ranger stations, whatever the season offered.

After the war, collectors and travelers found the Tetons too. Galleries opened on the Town Square, then art fairs, then a national museum. By the 1960s, art here was no longer something made at the edge of a ranching town. It had become one of its largest industries.

Jackson is now a major arts community. It is also an expensive place for artists to stay.

Which is why we keep a room for one. This valley was painted long before it was protected, and that work helped make the case for protection. We think that work is still worth housing.



WHAT'S NEXT

Where we're headed, and what we can do better.

2026 · WHAT WE DID

In 2026, we took the time to renovate Alpine House without tearing down what was already here. In a town where older buildings are increasingly replaced rather than restored, we chose to keep the house, work with its existing structure, and build on what was already there.

We worked with an architect trained in historic preservation and completed a MindClick assessment of the health and environmental characteristics of the materials we used.

We created a permanent space for our Uncommon Artists.

And for the first time, we measured the property's responsibility footprint in full with the Center for Responsible Hospitality.



WHERE WE FALL SHORT

Keeping an older building rather than replacing it was the right choice for us, but it means the house costs more to heat and run. That is something we need to keep working on.

Energy made up almost half of our carbon footprint in 2025, so we switched to renewable electricity. Renewable electricity made that energy cleaner but we still use more energy than similar hotels in Wyoming.

Not everyone on our team earns a Teton County living wage yet. Most do, but not everyone. We also focus on buying locally from Jackson, and we know we can keep more of our spending close to home.



WHAT WE'RE BUILDING

We will keep measuring our footprint so we can set targets, decide where to focus, and see whether the changes we make are actually working.

We're working to increase team wages, expand local spending, and deepen partnerships with local businesses and makers.

Our community partnership spend is tied to our sister property, the Anvil. Like the Anvil, we are looking to commit 3% of our profits.

HOW WE HOLD OURSELVES TO IT

We are the first property to conduct both a renovation assessment based on reusable materials and an operational assessment with MindClick and CRH.

We will publish our results each year, including where we can do better.

We will join the Anvil in pursuing BEST certification with Jackson's local business coalition.





WHAT YOU CAN DO

Travel like you mean to come back

A few ways to be a better guest, here and anywhere.

Come downstairs.

The living room. The lawn. The bar in the evening. The best part of a stay is rarely in the room, and it's hard to know a place if you only know your own four walls.

Talk to the people who work here.

Not just for directions. They live here, and they'll tell you what a visitor can't see: what's changed, what's worth protecting, where they go on their day off.

Be the guest who notices.

Hans Kleiber, whose etchings hang in our lobby, was discovered by a guest at a guest ranch who looked closely and did something about it. If a piece of work stops you, here, at a market, in a gallery, ask about it. And if you can, buy it. In a town this expensive, that helps artists stay.

Look past the scenery.

Go to a reading, an opening, a talk at the historical society, a performance. Scenery tells you what a place looks like. Culture tells you what it thinks.

And learn a few of the older names. The Shoshone called the Tetons Teewinot, meaning many pinnacles. People have come to this valley for eleven thousand years.



Read the local paper. Turn on the radio.

The Jackson Hole News&Guide and KHOL 89.1 will tell you more about what this town values, and argues about, than any guidebook.

Do the unexpected.

Most people come here for the mountain or for Yellowstone, and most do the same handful of things. Ask someone who lives here what they do on a Saturday. Then go and do it.

Leave the car.

The town is walkable. The pathways run out to the elk refuge and beyond. The START bus goes to the mountain. You see more at the speed of a bicycle, and it's one less car on streets the people who live here already find full.

Rent, borrow, repair.

Rent gear from a local outfitter or buy it secondhand from one of Jackson's consignment shops. Borrow a book from our library or the Teton County library down the road. If something breaks, get it fixed here.

198 miles

This valley has no landfill of its own. Anything you throw away makes a 198-mile round trip to be buried somewhere else.

Hold us to it.

We've published what we measure and where we fall short. Ask about it while you're here, and read next year's numbers.



Notes on the numbers and the work behind them.

Measured and verified with the Center for Responsible Hospitality, in partnership with MindClick.

DEFINITIONS

CARBON FOOTPRINT
Energy used per available room, compared against similar hotels.

EMBODIED CARBON
The one-time emissions locked into the materials and construction of our 2017 renovation, reported separately from annual operations.

EMPLOYEES IN SUBSIDIZED HOUSING
Staff housed in accommodation the hotel provides at a subsidized rate.

ENERGY
Energy used per occupied room, compared against similar hotels.

INDEPENDENT, VALUES-ALIGNED MANAGEMENT
A hotel run by an independent operator rather than a large brand or third-party management company applying standardized, chain-wide requirements. The Anvil is managed by Arbus Hospitality, an independent operator of a small collection of hotels that shares our commitment to place, community, and responsible operations.

NON-INSTITUTIONAL OWNERSHIP
Ownership held by private individuals rather than investment funds, REITs, or other large financial institutions. Our investors are friends and family, most of whom live in or spend significant time in Jackson.

PROFITS DONATED
Our donations to community organizations as a share of the hotel's profits.

PARTNERSHIPS WITH LOCAL NON-PROFITS
Ownership held by private individuals rather than investment funds, REITs, or other large financial institutions.

RENEWABLE ENERGY
The share of the electricity we purchase that comes from renewable sources.

SPEND WITH TOP SUPPLIERS
The share of spending with our top ten suppliers that goes to businesses in Jackson and Wyoming.

SUPPLIERS BASED IN JACKSON
The share of our suppliers, by number, that are based in Jackson.

TEAM MEMBERS LIVING LOCALLY
Staff who live within a 45-minute commute of the hotel.

WASTE
Waste produced per occupied room night, compared against similar hotels.

WATER
Water used per occupied room, compared against similar hotels.

BENCHMARK SOURCES

MEASURE	SOURCE	YEAR
Operational data	CRH / Honest Operations, from Anvil invoices & primary records	2024
Energy, water & carbon benchmarks	Cornell Hotel Sustainability Benchmarking Index (CHSB), 2025 edition; Wyoming, non-resort / non-metro, median values	2024 data
Waste benchmark	Cornell Hotel Sustainability Benchmarking Index (CHSB), 2025 edition; Upper upscale hotels	2024 data
Local-workforce baseline (Jackson)	Teton Community Well-Being Dashboard	2024
Women in leadership benchmark	Zippia dataset, derived from BLS and US Census data	2023

How we calculated our carbon footprint

Our carbon accounting follows the Hotel Carbon Measurement Initiative (HCMI), which conforms to the international standards for greenhouse-gas accounting: the GHG Protocol Corporate Standard and its Corporate Value Chain (Scope 3) Standard, and ISO 14064-1. Embodied carbon (our 2017 renovation) follows ISO 14067, the standard for product carbon footprints.

Scope 1 — direct, on-site emissions: refrigerants only. The Anvil is all-electric, so we burn no natural gas, oil, or other fuels on site and produce no combustion emissions. Our only direct emissions come from refrigerant leakage in cooling and refrigeration equipment, which we account for in our footprint.

Scope 2 — purchased energy: emissions from the electricity we buy to run the building.

Scope 3 — indirect, off-site emissions: outsourced laundry, business travel, water, and waste hauling.

How we incorporated our renovations

To understand the impact of our renovation, we worked with MindClick to estimate what a conventional "buy-new" renovation would have cost and subtracted what Alpine actually did. For each category, we modeled a baseline scenario: case goods, seating, and fabrics bought new, most likely manufactured in China and shipped by ocean freight to Los Angeles and trucked to Jackson. Using MindClick's product-level assessment and industry manufacturing and transport data, we estimated the factory emissions (energy, water, and waste) and the shipping emissions that baseline would have generated, then subtracted the actual impact of sourcing vintage and salvaged pieces regionally and the difference being the emissions avoided. We applied the same logic to waste, cataloguing everything that was saved and reused, and counting the reused case goods as diverted from landfill.

How we measured waste

Jackson has no local landfill so our waste footprint reflects hauling and disposal, not just volume. We built the figure from monthly invoices (January–December 2024) and applied established factors:

Landfill methane	0.52 MT CO_2e/ton (Teton County ISWR tip-fee data + EPA WARM v15, 2023)
Collection	0.056 MT CO_2e/MT (EPA WARM v15, 2023)
Transport	1.39 kg CO_2e/mile (198-mile round trip, Teton County → Idaho Falls)
Truck capacity	21.96 tons per haul
Fill rate	60%, held constant across years for comparability
Density	138 lbs/yd³ (EPA Volume-to-Weight Conversion Factors, 2016)

Fill-rate note: extra pickups peak in summer and fall near zero in winter, so real fill rates likely run above 60% in peak season and below it in winter. We use a flat 60% for consistency across years.

The honest limits

- Waste benchmarks for hotels are still scarce. The most recent study, just published, measures waste globally and by broad hotel type, not by region, so this is a broad comparison rather than a precise one. Even though our numbers come in below that benchmark, we still treat waste as a priority: Jackson has no landfill, and everything thrown away here is hauled out of the valley.
- Our electricity is renewable through Lower Valley Energy's 100% Green Power program: we pay a premium so every kilowatt-hour we use is matched with certified renewable power, mostly wind from Idaho's Horse Butte Wind Farm and small hydro in western Wyoming. The power reaching the house comes from the same shared grid as everyone else's, which in winter includes coal; what changes is what our electricity bill pays for. Our carbon figures use market-based accounting to reflect that.
- Our local-workforce figure (90%, within a 45-minute commute) covers a broader area than Jackson's town limits; the 57% community baseline is measured differently and is shown for context, not as a like-for-like comparison.



This house was built so strangers would end up in the same room.

Thanks for being one of them.



ALPINE HOUSE

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AN IMPACT REPORT PREPARED IN PARTNERSHIP WITH

CENTER FOR RESPONSIBLE HOSPITALITY

READ THE FULL REPORT ONLINE